

FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC MUBI

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

COURSE TITLE: INTRODUCTION TO SOCIOLOGY

COURSE CODE: SOC 211

COURSE OUTLINE

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- 1b- Importance of sociology**
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MEANING OF SOCIOLOGY: The word Sociology came from two words: "socio" and "logos."

"Socio" is the Latin word for society, and "logos" is a Greek word for science of the society. The discipline focuses on human behavior and relationships, investigating how these relationships influence and develop over time. Sociology is defined as a social science field that adopts scientific methodology to the study of human behavior and human societies. It is the study of how human beings relate with one another and how their relationships have been influenced by other people. Sociology emphasizes group relations and the total social environment.

Sociology is also defined as that intellectual discipline concerned with developing systematic and reliable knowledge about all aspects of human social behavior and the society at large. It is also viewed as a branch of study that deals with the scientific explanation of human societies, which includes customs, traditions, and values which emerge from group living, as well as the ways group living in turn affects these customs, values, and traditions. The scientific nature of sociology involves the methods that sociologists employ and the methods of sciences in the study of society.

Auguste Comte, a French scholar, is often considered as the founding father of sociology. He coined the term sociology, which is derived from two words: "socio," meaning society, and "logos," meaning science from the Greek word. He defined sociology as the scientific study of society, its Structure and the Laws of its development.

August Comte believed that Sociology should use the same scientific method as the natural science to study social phenomena. He also emphasized that important of for understanding the historical development of societies in order to comprehend their current state.

Sociology is one of the social science fields which includes economics, geography that try to understand and explain human behavior and its societies which caught race, religion, ethnic, and

all social groups. Sociology is unlike some social sciences, such as economics it does not confine itself to one particular area of social life. Indeed, sociologists have studied a vast and diverse range of topics including sexuality, ethnic conflict, poverty, drugs use, the Law, War, migration, religion, deviant, and crime in human society, etc.

It is hard to think of any significant area of social life which has never been the subject of a sociological study. It is more useful to define sociology in terms of its approach and approaches for explaining social life. Compared to psychology, sociology is much less concerned with human groups. The size of the groups studied in sociology can vary considerably, ranging from studies of delinquent goings or school classes or institutions such as education systems or the family. Sociology can also be defined as the study of the whole system of human societies.

IMPORTANCE OF SOCIOLOGY: Prior to the emergence of sociology, the study of society was carried on an unscientific manner and society had never been the central concern of any science. It is through the study sociology that the truly scientific study of the society has been possible. Sociology studies role of the institutions in the development of the individuals. It is through sociology that scientific study of the great social institutions and the relation of the individual to each is been made. The home and family, the school and education, the church and religion, the state, government, industry and work, the community and associations. These are institutions through which society function.

Sociology studies these institution and their role in the development of the individual and suggest suitable measure for strengthening them with a view to enable them to serve the individual better.

The study of sociology is indispensable for the understanding and planning of society and human relationships. It is impossible to understand and solve the numerous problems of human society without the knowledge of its mechanisms and construct. Without the investigation carried out by sociology, no real effective social planning would be possible. It helps us to determine the most efficient means for reaching the goals agree upon.

A certain amount of knowledge about society is necessary before any social policy is carried out. Sociology is of great importance in the solution of social problems.

The present world is suffering from many problems which can be solved through the scientific study of the society. It is the task of sociology to study the social problems through the methods of scientific research and to find out solutions to them. The scientific study of human affairs will provide the body of knowledge and principles that will enable us to control the conditions of social life and improve them.

Sociology has changed our outlook with regard to the problem of crime. It is through the study of sociology that our whole outlook on various aspects of crime has changed. The criminals are now treated as human beings suffering from mental deficiencies or problems and efforts are accordingly made to rehabilitate them as useful members of society.

Another importance of sociology is that it helps us to know our society and the people around us. Their role, status, social structures, occupations, traditions, religion, and belief systems, social norms, culture, social institutions. Sociology also helps in solving the social problems in human societies and provides lasting solutions to the existing problems, in a society for instance, poverty, unemployment, illiteracy crime. The study of sociology is important to understand human interaction it teaches and helps one in the needed associations with the rest of the people in society.

RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN SOCIOLOGY AND OTHER SOCIAL SCIENCES

Sociology is closely related to other social sciences such as Anthropology, Psychology, Economics, Political science, and history. Each of these disciplines provides its own unique perspectives on human behavior and society, and they often intersect and overlap in their subject matter. For example, sociology and Anthropology both study human societies and culture but sociology tends to focus more on contemporary societies and social structures, while Anthropology often emphasizes the systematic study of humanity with the goal of understanding our evolutionary origins. Our distinctiveness as a species, and great diversity in our forms of social existence across the world and through time.

Similarly, sociology and psychology both study human behavior, but sociology tends to focus on the behavior of groups and societies, while psychology often emphasizes individual behavior and mental processes. These interdisciplinary connections allow for a more comprehensive understanding of human society and behavior.

Political science, depending on the philosophical direction, studies the management of political institutions that society depends on to function. It is a study of how government facilitates the needs of people and a study of power and how it is employed to represent particular groups of people. While sociology is the science of society, Economics is the study of production and distribution of goods and services. It is also the study of scarcity and its implications for the use of resources, production, of goods and services, growth of production and welfare over time.

MEANING OF SOCIAL GROUPS

A social group is any set of two or more people. It can be any grouping of two or more interacting people who recognize their relationship with each other as a distinct social unit. Social groups play

an important role in daily life and help human make meaning of the world around them. Social groups fulfill one of the basic psychological needs for survival, a sense of belonging from friendships to families to entire societies, human naturally form social groups, in fact, this tendency is essential to what it means to be human. Social group play an important role in daily life and help humans to make meaning of the world around them.

A social group consists of two or more people who regularly interact on the basis of mutual expectations and who share a common identity. It is easy to see from this definition that we all belong to many types of social group's e.g our families, our different friendship groups. The sociology class and other course we attend, our workplace, the clubs and organizations to which we belong. Except in rare cases, it is difficult to imagine any of us living totally alone. Even people who live by themselves still interact with family members, coworkers, and friends to the extent still have several group memberships. It is important here to understand that social group's inevitable to human life.

TYPES OF SOCIAL GROUPS:

1. Primary Group
2. Secondary Group
3. Reference Group

1. **Primary Group:** Is a small social group where the members have direct intimate, and long-term connections. Primary group are defined by the standard care, join projects, and extended period devoted as group. The group aims at relationships rather than achieving goals. For instance these friends can surprise members in primary groups, people share implicit qualities like care, love, worry, and encouragement. A nuclear family crisis support

network, and church group are primary group examples. Connections built in primary groups are long term and serve as the objective. Primary groups in sociology are beneficial to the members as they serve as a sources of help and motivation.

2. **Secondary Group:** as opposed to primary ones, are large groups with emotionless or goat based connections, members of a secondary group connect on a less intimate level. Secondary group member's relationship are often short term instead of long term. Other secondary groupings continue for several years. Secondary groups are not based on emotional connection and lack intimate relationships. According to Charles Cooley the distinction between primary and secondary groups. He classified groups as primary since individuals frequently encounter the groups in the early phase of life. Such groupings play a vital function in the creation of personal identity. The secondary groups typically emerge later in an individual's life and seldom impact their personality.

3. **Reference Group:** is a group to which an individual or another group is compared used by sociologists in reference to any group that is used by an individual as a standard for evaluating themselves and their own behaviors, such groups are used to evaluate their own qualities, value, attitude, behaviors.

IMPORTANCE OF SOCIAL GROUP: from friendship to families to entire societies, humans naturally from social groups, in fact, this tendency is essential to what it means to be human. A social group is any grouping of two or more interacting people who recognized their relationship with each other as a distinct social unit. Social group play an important role in daily life and help humans make meaning of the world around them.

Another important of social group is that it help to fulfil one of the basic psychological needs for survival, a sense of belonging, feeling needed and affect mental health. For this reason, belonging

is an important element of maslow's hierarchy of needs. In this model, humans must first meet their psychological needs for survival, including shelter, food and basic bodily functions. Once they meet these needs they must meet less tangible needs like safety and a sense of belonging. It is important to note that social groups act as a great support system when needed. Groups can identify problems and unify to help solve them or increase the member's quality of life.

CULTURE: Every Society is characterized by a particular way of life that stipulates the way of thinking, acting or feelings of its members, this particular way of life is referred to as Culture. In sociology, sense culture refers to totality of which is acquired, learned, by individuals as members of society, to a large extent culture determines how members of a society think and feel, it guide their action and defines their outlook on life. When speak of Culture, we therefore refer to a man's learned behavior, socially passed on from one generation to another generation.

According to Edward Taylor, Culture refers to that complex whole of man which includes knowledge, belief, art, morals, law, custom, and any other capabilities acquired by man as a member of society. Furthermore, culture consist of pattern of behavior acquired and transmitted by symbols of artifact. Such pattern of behavior are based on traditional ideas and values characterized by specific human group

TYPES OF CULTURE:

1. **Materials culture**
2. **Non Materials culture**
1. **Material Culture:** This consists of those aspects of culture that can be physically seen and acted upon in society. According to Oritie and Ogwunwo (1985) material culture relates to the overt or explicit aspect of culture, and means that products of industry, technology, art

etc that very visible or concrete acquisition of man in society, artifacts such as bridges, pots, cutlery, hoes, houses, cooking utensils, handicrafts, etc these are directly observable as the cultural products of any society.

2. **Non-Material Culture:** on the other hand is those aspects of culture that are looked up in people's heads and cannot be subjected to physical contact. For instance non material culture consists of those things that have no physical existence such as language, ideas, knowledge and behaviors.

CHARACTERISTIC OF CULTURE

1. Culture is learned and does not depend on biological inheritance for its transmission. Every person learns his culture by being exposed to it and growing up in it. The process whereby culture is transmitted from one generation to another is called socialization or enculturation.
2. Culture is shared: it is a system that is shared by the members of a society considered collectively rather than individuals. While the extent to which various individuals may internalize or conform to the pattern of their culture.
3. Culture rests on symbolic interaction, the most important symbolic aspect of culture is language; it is through language that man is able to transmit culture from one generation to another.
4. Culture is integrated: this means that the various components of culture tend to fit together in such a way that there are consistent with one another, despite the conflicts, frictions or contradictions that are present.

IMPORTANCE OF CULTURE

1. Culture is extremely important for the survival of any human society, it is required for the proper functioning of the system. Culture stipulates the dos and don'ts of the society, it prescribes and proscribes.
2. Culture sets standard for action, this implies that culture determines appropriate behaviors expected of any individuals in society.
3. Culture helps to maintain social organization like the family, marriage, peer groups. It foster order interaction within those groups
4. Culture influences individual action, we marry have children get a job buy or build a new home, settled down to life in general affluence and so on, because that is what our culture teaches us to expect out of life.
5. Culture motivates it members to survive and engage in the activities necessary for survival e.g production of hoes, cutlasses and other art work.
6. Culture help to teaches us how to maintain order among members, it also teach us to maintain order with outsiders or other members of society.
7. Culture help to socialize a member so that they can become functional adults and socially competent members of society.
8. Culture help to maintain continuity in tense of biological production of offspring's.

MEANING OF SOCIALIZATION: According to Haralambos, Holborn (2013) Socialization is the process by which individuals learn about the ways of the society. This process enables the individual to acquire the right attitude necessary for living in the society. The individual through socialization learns about the values, norms, and cultures of the society where he is being born in to or where he resides. Socialization start from birth and end at death. This is because knowledge

is a never ending process, one continues to learn and adjust to the norms and standards of the society until he dies. Socialization is important in not only to the life of an individuals but to the society as well. Socialization makes the individual to be law abiding, obedient and discipline in the society. Furthermore, the term socialization is define as the process by which individuals learn the ways of a given society or social group well enough so that he can function within it. In a more general term socialization means a process through which individuals acquired the social knowledge and technicalities necessary to enable them interact with others, in a specific sense, it is the process by which we acquire the culture of the society into which we belong. This process peruses throughout an individual's life, the common knowledge to all society is that children are born socially incompetent, yet gradual they manage to develop into socially competent adult.

AGENT OF SOCIALIZATION

1. the family
 2. peer group
 3. educational system
 4. mass media
1. The family: this is the first agent of socialization, it is the parents and other family members that the child first receives social training. The mother is a very variable in the respect because she is the closest to the means in which the child grows. She starts teaching the child the basic norms of the family and society. Similarly in extendend family they begins to learn from family members.
 2. Peer group: this refers to the ones age mates or colleagues whom the child grows up with and plays with, peer group usually influences and affect the behavior of their members in the society as they normally have values and norms which their members are expected to

abide by. it is contended that by interacting and playing children's games with others, the child learn to conform to acceptable behavior patterns of a socially group.

3. **The school:** here is another powerful agent of socialization which shapes the character and behavior of the child in line with the norms and values of the society. It is also at the school that the child is impacted with basic skills that would guarantee him or her a brighter future in the society. e.g nursery, primary, secondary and tertiary.

4. **Mass media:** the mass media have consist of both print and electronic media. This mass media has the basic function of not only entertaining the individuals but also of educating and inspiring them in the society. The mass media teaches the individuals about current trends and events in the society in addition to shaping behavior through articles, news talk e.t.c.

IMPORTANCE OF SOCIALIZATION.

1. Socialization helps the individuals to control his or her unborn derives which if not controlled ultimately lead to socially disruptive behavior. this is because of individuals desires
2. Socialization helps one to acquire role and their supportive attitudes in the society.
3. Socialization helps to inculcate basic discipline in the life of the individuals. Discipline is crucial to the maintenance of law and order in the society.
4. Socialization teaches skills and encourage child aspiration to the society as a member of the society.
5. Socialization helps the individual to acquire the right attitudes necessary for living in the society.

SOCIAL STRATIFICATIONS: The term Social Stratification is derived from the geographical Concept 'Strata' which relates to this arrangement of rocks into Layers. Invariably, when rocks are observed, one finds that different types of rocks are placed in different layers or Strata and they assume different name. Social Stratification can be define as the hierarchical arrangement of individuals in the Society Using certain Value attributes such as Wealth, Power, prestige, honor, Skills etc. by this, individuals are viewed as super-ordinates, coordinates or Subs ordinate. The term Social Stratification refers to how Societies categorized people, based on factors such as Wealth, income, education, family, background and power. Social Stratification exists in all Societies in some form. The importance of Stratification is that those at the top up the hierarchy have greater access to scare resources than those at the bottom.

TYPES OF SOCIAL STRATIFICATION

1. Slavery
 2. Castes
 3. Estates
 4. Social Classes
1. Slavery: this is a system of inequality which encouraged the ownership of man by his fellow man. Under this system the owner can use the slave for anything he wishes, he can equally sell him any time he feels he is alright with the Services of the slave. Slaves have no rights and were not regarded.
 2. Castes: the caste is a closed system where there is no provision where one can change his class position through hard work, the cast system does not make provision for such a Chang. in other word, one remains in the casts into which he was born forever unless he dies. Even where he

dies his children will remain there to continue the cycle. The System is foreclosed irrespective of the effort and Struggles of the individual.

3. **Estates.** The estate System is associated with the Middle Ages in Europe especially among feudal Society. This System rested on land related obligations where the peasants were required to work for the nobility under certain conditions and arrangement especially for military protection.

4. **Social Classes:** this is associated with the capitalist mode of production. Unlike the other System, Class System thrives in an open system and provides the individual with the freedom and prospects of moving up or down the class Structure. This system allows for labor and occupational mobility. People are rated and regarded based on the density of their achievement.

FAMILY: According to Burgess and Locke family is define as a group of persons united by ties of marriage, common residence, economic cooperation, reproduction, interaction and communication with each other in their respective social roles of husband and wife, mother and father, brother and sisters creating and maintaining common culture. This definition is widely accepted by many sociologists. Family is also define as a set of people who are related by blood, marriage, ancestry, adoption or any other relationship that may be acceptable in the society. This definition implies that it is not only those who are related to us by blood that we may regards as members of our family through marriage, adoption or ancestry.

TYPES OF FAMILY

1. Nuclear family
2. Extended family

1. **Nuclear family:** this is also known as conjugal or elementary family. Nuclear family is the family that comprises of a man, his wife and children. This kind of family is characteristic of western societies.

2. **Extended family:** the extended family is composed of father, mother, children, spouses, cousins, uncles, aunts, nephews, nieces, extended relative etc. the extended family can comprises of generations of relative living either within the same household, very closed or scattered within the community. The extended family is characteristic of African societies where those who are related by blood are relatives (distance or close relatives)

MARRIAGE: To a layman, marriage is seen as a union of man and woman for sexual and child rearing. Though this notion is somewhat relevant, yet marriage goes beyond it. There have been recent developments in the Society with regards to Marriage and Sociologist have in their definition of marriage accommodated these developments in their definition of marriage. One thing that is central to the various definitions of the term is the fact that it is an arrangement or a union that is both socially and legally approved.

Some Marital forms may be socially acceptable or approved and yet not legally approved. On the other hand, a union may be legally approved but yet not socially acceptable. For example, there are Some Societies that approve ghost marriage, but legally the Law does not recognize such marriage. Also there are Countries like Britain and united States of America Where lesbian and gay marriage are Legal, but some cultures within these countries still dis approve.

SOCIAL MOBILITY: is refers to the shift in an individual's social status from one status to another. The shift can either be higher or lower, inter-generational or Intra- generational, and it cannot necessarily be determined if the Change is for good or bad. Russian born American

Sociologist and political activist Pitirirn Sorokin first introduced the concept of social mobility. He states that there is no society that is completely open or closed like the caste system in India.

According to Sorokin the Social Mobility can change from one time period to the next, it depends on how developed the Society is such a Societal Shift can happen over time as individuals move from one position to another due to various Social interactions. Mobility more or less provides people with benefits as they are motivated by different factors in Society and work to reach new roles that offer them a better Standard of living and greater rewards. People compete and cooperate with others in Society to move the Social Mobility up Ladder.

TYPES OF SOCIAL MOBILITY

Horizontal mobility: This occurs when a person Changes their occupation but their overall Social Standard remains unchanged for example, if a doctor goes from practicing medicine to teaching in a medical School the occupations Changed but their prestige and Social Standard likely remain the same.

Vertical Mobility: this refers to a change in the occupational, like political or religious status of a person that causes a change in their societal position. An individual moves from a one social Stratum to another. Vertical mobility can be ascending or descending e.g from up to down or from down to up.

Upward Mobility: this is when a person moves from a lower position in the Society to a higher one. It can also include people occupying higher positions in the Same Societal group. However upward mobility, while seen as a good thing can also come at a cost for individuals. When a person move upward, they often need to leave behind familiar Surrounding such as family and places.

They may also need to change their way of thinking and behavior, the individual will need to adapt to the new environment.

Downward Mobility: Downward mobility take Place When a person move from a higher position in Society to a lower one. It can occur when someone is caught performing a wrongful act that can result in the loss of the position they currently hold: It can be stressful of the person involved and can face rapid decline or hard to adapt to new environment.

Inter-generational Mobility: this happen when the social position changes from one generation to another. The change can be upward or downward. For example, a Father worked in a factory while his Son become to become Lawyer or medical doctor.

DEVIANCE: Deviance simply refers to activities, actions or behaviors that do not conform to the norms and expectations of a particular Social group. Any behavior that violates Cultural norms is regarded as deviance. Sociologists use the form as an inevitable component of any society. According Durkheim which he was actually emphasizing the fact that deviance is a fundamental component of any Society. There may not have been, neither would there ever be any society when all the members conform to the collective sentiment as there will always be deviants. Deviance is often divided into two, the first is **Crime** which simply refers to the violation of formally enacted laws. This is often referred to as formal deviance and it examples include robbery, theft, rape, murder, assault etc the second type of deviant behavior refers to informal deviance behavior which means violation of informal social norms. e.g disrespect to elders, drunkenness, improper dressing smoking in public, jumping queue e.t.c.